

Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP)

Pathways to Authentic College Experiences (PACE)

Federal regulations require financial aid recipients to maintain “satisfactory academic progress (SAP)” towards the program’s recognized certificates and completion requirements. Satisfactory academic progress applies to all students who receive any type of financial assistance administered by the university.

Each required aspect of the program’s course of study will be assessed to determine satisfactory progress across all domains. Wherever appropriate, this SAP aligns directly with the policy of the University. See the [Undergraduate Day Satisfactory Academic Progress \(SAP\) Policy](#) for reference. Details below indicate the additions/modifications to the existing SAP policy for our university that apply to students in the CTP program.

The modified academic program of the Pathways to Authentic College Experiences (PACE) at Saint Joseph’s University requires students to progress toward their Integrated Professional Studies certificate in eight standard (fall and spring) semesters in which a minimum of three courses are taken on an audit basis each semester. Following such a program, a student will have completed a minimum of 24 courses by the end of the eighth semester. Students enrolled in the PACE program are also required to complete a prescribed number of social and work-based learning activities per week (which varies throughout the course of the program) as a part of the program of study.

Satisfactory academic progress in the PACE program at Saint Joseph’s University requires students to successfully complete a minimum of six courses on an audit basis in each academic year, beginning in September and ending in August. Audited courses will appear on the student’s official transcript and on the official record with the grade “X.” Satisfactory academic progress in all audited courses will be assessed at the end of each semester by program staff. PACE program staff will regularly check-in with course instructors to assess whether students are making satisfactory academic progress in accordance with their person-centered plans. A rubric will be used to determine if students adequately meet all goals and expectations (i.e. satisfactory attendance, appropriate classroom behavior, and completion of modified assignments) established in both the individualized learning agreements and modified syllabi. Additionally, students enrolled in the PACE program are required to complete a prescribed number of academic coaching hours per week with their peer mentor; at the end of each semester, PACE

program staff will review academic coaching logs to ensure that students have met this requirement. Students are also required to complete a prescribed number of Independent Study Hours per week.

Students enrolled in the PACE program must complete a prescribed number of hours per week engaged in social activities with their peer mentor or on their own participating in campus extracurricular activities; requirements will range throughout the duration of the program (between 1 and 10 hours per week for social coaching and 1 and 10 hours per week for campus extracurriculars). A review of records will take place at the end of each semester to ensure that students have met this requirement. Moreover, informal assessment (e.g. direct observation, self-report, and review of peer-reports) will take place regularly throughout the semester to assess students' progress towards social goals, as outlined in their person-centered plans.

Lastly, students are required to complete a prescribed number of hours per week engaged in work-based learning activities, which may include, but are not limited to, paid or unpaid internships, employment, or job training. The hourly requirement per week for work-based activities ranges from 6 to 20 weekly hours, depending on the students' year in the program. Students must participate in weekly employment coaching with a peer coach (between 2 and 3 hours per week); this requirement will be monitored by an ongoing log, which will be reviewed at the end of each semester. Additionally, students will be assessed regularly by program staff, employment coaches, and supervisors to determine whether they are meeting the expectations of the worksite and making progress toward their employment goals, which are established in their person-centered plans.

Students will self-reflect on their progress in each of the required program components weekly with the Program Director using the Student Evaluation Sheet.

It is the policy of Saint Joseph's University to allow for a ninth and sometimes a tenth semester if significant reasons justify such an extension. Permission for a ninth or tenth semester will ordinarily be obtained from the associate academic Dean of the appropriate college. The Deans of the Colleges reserve the right to consider special cases differing from the above statement.

Students who receive federal, state, or University aid need to maintain satisfactory academic progress in order to keep their eligibility. Evaluation of a student's academic progress to determine financial assistance eligibility will be made at the end of the spring semester. Students not meeting criteria for satisfactory progress will be informed in early summer that their current academic record disqualifies them for financial assistance.

Students should not assume that Saint Joseph's University will recommend and/or award financial assistance for more than eight semesters. Students intending to complete their degree program in more than eight semesters should first consult with the appropriate academic Dean and the Student Financial Services Office.

In addition to the quantitative parameter of a minimum of six courses on an audit basis within each academic year as a requirement for retaining financial assistance, Saint Joseph's University also adheres to the qualitative parameter defined as follows:

Wherever appropriate, the University policies and procedures for academic probation, academic suspension, and academic dismissal will be applied for SJU students enrolled through PACE. However, since students enrolled through PACE will be auditing courses, GPA requirements do not apply. For SJU students enrolled through PACE, **academic probation** will be considered based on the students' academic progress in audited courses (in lieu of a GPA requirement). Students who fail to successfully complete at least 67% of their credits audited (as determined by their learning agreement for audited courses), are placed on probation by the PACE Program Director. Additionally, students who fail to successfully complete non-academic requirements of the program, such as excessive absences from required program components (work-based learning opportunities, social activities, coaching sessions, person-centered planning meetings, etc.), are placed on academic probation by the PACE Program Director. A student on probation is required to report to the PACE Program Director, who may prescribe appropriate remedial measures.

The standard period of probation will extend one semester, during which time the student must show sufficient improvement to successfully complete at least 67% of their credits audited and/or successfully complete the non-academic requirements of the program. In extraordinary cases, one additional semester of probation may be allowed by the PACE Team if the improvement during the first probationary semester indicates that the student will probably reach the necessary level by the end of the second probationary semester. A student may be permitted as many as three semesters of probations, provided that no more than two are consecutive. A student on academic probation is ineligible to participate in major extracurricular activities, including intercollegiate athletics, or to serve as officer or director of any student activity.

A student who is showing slow improvement in their level of performance or rate of progress during this period of probation may be subject to **academic suspension** by the PACE Program Director on the recommendation of the PACE Team. While a student is traditionally granted at least one academic probation before suspension, the PACE Team may recommend academic suspension without any probation when the student's progress and/or participation is so low

that the PACE Team determines an academic probation would not be in the student's best interest. A student enrolled through PACE who has been placed on suspension may return to Saint Joseph's University only after being away for one semester but not more than four semesters.

A student who fails to make sufficient improvement in their level of performance or rate of progress during the period of probation, or after coming back from suspension, may be subject to **academic dismissal** by the PACE program. Dismissal may also be considered based on non-academic program components, such as excessive absences from required program components (work-based learning opportunities, social activities, coaching sessions, person-centered planning meetings, etc.) or related to noncompliance with the university's policies (such as that related to college appropriate behavior, violence, aggression, safety compliance etc.).

While a student is traditionally granted at least one academic probation or suspension before dismissal, the PACE Team may recommend academic dismissal without any probation or suspension where the student's progress and/or participation is so low that the PACE Team determines an academic probation and/or suspension would not be in the student's best interest. A student who has been academically dismissed may not be a student at Saint Joseph's University in the future without formally re-applying for admission (and being readmitted) to the PACE program at Saint Joseph's University.